

The same world, twice

How to find things

Open the student hub on your phone or laptop and keep it open all class:
gordonusc.github.io/the-cabinet/ctin290-september-30/CLASSROOM/

The dark menu at the top of every page: **Run of show** (home), **Videos** (the scenes and clips), **My notes** (where you write), **Board finish** (12:15), **Terms, Rubrics, Class screens**. Amber marks the page you are on.

Today, block by block

10:00 to 10:10

The spine: three worlds that exist twice

The Last of Us, League and Arcane, Minecraft. Actual film and episode scenes beside the trailer and cinematic you know.
 Content note first.

10:10 to 10:42

Minecraft: the game trailer, then the film

One minute of the game, then up to four minutes of the film from Steve's introduction, stopping before the Nether.
 Crossing, or contradiction?

10:42 to 11:06

The Last of Us: the cold open

Up to four minutes of the series, stopping at the title card.
 What does the audience know before the characters do?

11:06 to 11:16

Break

Ten minutes. Leave the room.

11:16 to 11:46

Riot: Awaken, then Arcane's first scene

Same world, two visual languages. Awaken in full, then up to four minutes of Arcane, stopping at the first scene transition.

11:46 to 12:00

The three questions, in writing

One pair per team. What survived, what was reinvented, what is gone.

12:00 to 12:15

Engine craft bridge: Clair Obscur

Cinema made inside a game engine. What engines make easy, and what they still make hard.

12:15 to 12:45

Board finish: last hands on it

Count, palette, weakest image out. File due tomorrow, 5 PM.

12:45 to 12:50

Exit ticket

Two lines: one term and where you saw it, one thing you are unsure of.

What you will practice

1. Answer the three questions about one pair you watched today, in writing, with the third question argued rather than asserted.
2. Name one technique you think an engine made possible in the Clair Obscur trailer and the frame that supports it, as a hypothesis, plus one thing still hard.
3. Leave with your mood board counted, its palette checked against the screen, and its weakest image removed.

The three questions

1. What survived the crossing unchanged? 2. What had to be reinvented because the new medium could not carry the original? 3. What is simply gone, and is its absence felt?

The scenes and clips

- Minecraft, official trailer (the game), 1:00. Whose hands are building? Whose choice is every block?
- A Minecraft Movie: Steve's prologue, classroom cap 4:00 (on the classroom screen; no subscription needed). A world whose whole identity is that you built it, adapted into a form where you watch somebody else build it. Crossing, or contradiction?
- The Last of Us, season 1 episode 1, When You're Lost in the Darkness: the cold open, classroom cap 4:00 (on the classroom screen; no subscription needed). What does the audience know before the characters do? What would you expect from an ordinary family scene after this warning? If you remember the game's opening, what survived, and what is gone?
- League of Legends, Awaken (Season 2019 cinematic), 3:28. Photoreal light, painted skin, a world you could almost touch. What is this film for?
- Arcane, season 1 episode 1, Welcome to the Playground: the opening scene, classroom cap 4:00 (on the classroom screen; no subscription needed). A cinematic and a series episode from the same world. What audience expectation does each set up, and which frames or edits prove it?
- Clair Obscur: Expedition 33, launch trailer, 2:22. Lighting, camera and composition that look authored inside a game engine. Which techniques do you think you are seeing, and what in the frame supports that?

Content notes

The Minecraft prologue: comedy and mild fantasy peril. The Last of Us cold open: a 1968 talk show about pandemics, unsettling in idea. The Arcane opening: children grieving their parents, bodies and the aftermath of violence. The Clair Obscur trailer: fantasy violence at trailer intensity. You may look away or step out at any time.

Concepts

Adaptation. The crossing of a world from one medium into another. The useful question is never whether it is faithful. It is what survived unchanged, what had to be reinvented because the new medium could not carry the original, and what is simply gone.

What survived. The part of a world that crosses into the new medium unchanged: a name, a color, a silhouette, a rule, a relationship.

What was reinvented. The part that had to be rebuilt because the new medium cannot carry the original form.

What is gone. The part that simply does not come along, and the honest judgment of whether its absence is felt.

In-engine cinematography. Cinema authored inside a game engine: lighting, camera and composition built in the same tool that runs the game.

Finishing pass. A critique that adds nothing and removes what is weakest: count the images, say the palette, name the weakest image and cut it.

Board finish, 12:15 to 12:45

Count the images out loud. Say the palette, then check the screen. The room names the weakest image; cut it.

Dates

Mood-board file: tomorrow, Thursday October 1, 5 PM Pacific, to Drive. Presentations: Monday October 5, five minutes, everyone speaks. Homework, ungraded: three sentences on one thing your project can only do because it lives in an engine.

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